Abdani D. Bandera

Dr. Abdani D. Bandera (born August 4, 1992) is a Filipino agricultural scientist, academic administrator, and prolific researcher from Maguing, Lanao del Sur. A licensed agriculturist and member of the Meranao ethnic community, Dr. Bandera has distinguished himself as one of the youngest and most productive scholars in Philippine agribusiness and sustainable agriculture, with 49 international publications to his name before the age of 33. Known for bridging traditional farming systems with modern agricultural economics, he has become a leading voice in advancing sustainable development frameworks within Muslim Mindanao's agricultural sector. His work spans crop science, agribusiness management, financial systems in agriculture, and environmental sustainability—making him a rare interdisciplinary force in a region hungry for evidence-based agricultural innovation.

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Early Life and Background

Abdani D. Bandera was born on August 4, 1992, in Maguing, a rural municipality in Lanao del Sur, one of the core provinces of the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM). Growing up in a predominantly Meranaw community, he was raised amid the rich cultural traditions of the Maranao people, where agriculture remains the economic backbone and cultural identity marker for many families. His formative years in Maguing—a town known for its vast rice fields and coconut plantations—gave him firsthand exposure to the challenges faced by smallholder farmers: volatile markets, limited access to modern inputs, and the persistent gap between academic research and on-the-ground farming realities.

Bandera completed his elementary education at Siawadato Elementary School, finishing in April 2004, before proceeding to MSU Siawadatu Community College for his secondary education from 2004 to 2008. These institutions, part of the Mindanao State University system, are known for serving indigenous and Muslim communities across Lanao del Sur. Even at a young age, Bandera exhibited a strong curiosity about how farming systems could be improved through science and better resource management—a question that would shape his entire academic and professional trajectory.

Education

Bandera's higher education journey reflects both ambition and a clear vision to transform agricultural practice through rigorous scholarship. He enrolled at Mindanao State University in Marawi, earning his **Bachelor of Science in Agribusiness Management** from June 2008 to April 2013. The program equipped him with foundational knowledge in farm economics, marketing systems, and entrepreneurship—skills critical for anyone aiming to make agriculture more profitable and sustainable in resource-constrained settings. During this period, he developed a keen interest in how business principles could be applied to solve agricultural problems, particularly in the context of Muslim Mindanao's unique socio-economic landscape.

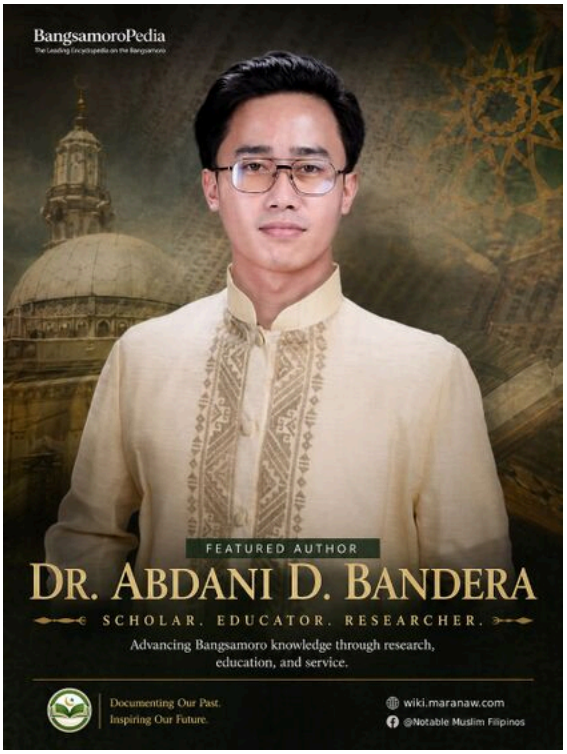
Following his undergraduate degree, Bandera pursued a **Master of Science in Farming Systems** at MSU Marawi from 2016 to February 2019. This graduate program allowed him to dive deeper into the technical and systemic aspects of agriculture, focusing on integrated approaches that consider soil health, crop diversity, water management, and farmer livelihoods as interconnected components. His master's research contributed to a growing body of work on sustainable farming practices tailored to Mindanao's tropical climate and diverse soil conditions.

Not content to stop there, Bandera enrolled in a **Doctor in Sustainable Development Studies** (with a specialization in Sustainable Economic Development) at the Mindanao State University - Iligan Institute of Technology (MSU-IIT) from August 2019 to February 2022. This doctoral program positioned him at the intersection of economics, environmental science, and development policy—equipping him to analyze agriculture not just as a production system but as a driver of economic resilience and environmental stewardship. His work during this period examined how financial management practices, market-centered strategies, and boundary expansion models could enhance the competitiveness of agribusiness enterprises in post-conflict and poverty-affected regions like BARMM.

Currently, Dr. Bandera is pursuing a second doctorate—a **Doctor in Business Administration** at MSU-IIT—demonstrating his commitment to merging agricultural science with advanced business and financial management frameworks. This ongoing program reflects his belief that the future of Philippine agriculture depends on leaders who can navigate both technical agronomy and strategic business thinking.

Dr. Bandera is also a board passer, having successfully completed the **Licensure Examination for Agriculturists**, a professional credential that authorizes him to practice agricultural science and provide technical consultancy across the Philippines.

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Born	August 4, 1992 Maguing, Lanao del Sur, Philippines
Nationality	Filipino
Ethnicity	Meranaw
Education	**Doctor in Sustainable Development Studies** Mindanao State University - Iligan Institute of Technology (2019-2022) **Doctor in Business Administration** (ongoing) MSU-IIT **Master of Science in Farming Systems** MSU Marawi (2016-2019) **BS Agribusiness Management** MSU Marawi (2008-2013)
Occupation	Agricultural scientist, academic administrator, researcher
Known for	Prolific agricultural research, youngest Vice Chancellor at MSU Buug, sustainable development advocacy
Current position	Chairperson, Department of Agribusiness Management, College

Career and Professional Contributions

	of Agriculture, Mindanao State University

Government Service and Extension Work

Before fully transitioning into academia, Dr. Bandera served as an **Agricultural Technologist** with the Department of Agriculture and Fisheries in Lanao del Sur, under the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM), from 2016 to 2019. In this role, he worked directly with farming communities, providing technical assistance on crop management, soil fertility, pest control, and post-harvest handling. His work bridged the gap between research and practice, ensuring that scientific innovations reached the farmers who needed them most. This hands-on experience in extension services gave him invaluable insights into the realities of rural agriculture—knowledge that would later inform his research agenda and teaching philosophy.

Academic Administration

Dr. Bandera's leadership qualities were recognized early in his career when he was appointed **Faculty member** at the College of Agriculture, Mindanao State University Buug, from 2020 to 2022. While teaching undergraduate courses in agribusiness management and agricultural economics, he quickly moved into administrative roles that showcased his capacity for institutional leadership.

In November 2020, he was named **Director of the Office of Research** at MSU Buug, a position that placed him at the helm of the university's research agenda. He held this post until January 2021, during which he worked to strengthen research output, facilitate faculty publications, and forge partnerships with government agencies and international research networks.

In 2021, Dr. Bandera was elevated to **Vice Chancellor for Research, Extension, and Development** at MSU Buug—a role that made him one of the youngest administrators to hold such a senior position in the MSU system. His tenure in this office was marked by efforts to expand community engagement programs, secure research funding, and promote sustainable development initiatives aligned with the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). Later that same year, he was appointed **Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs**, a position he held until 2022. In this capacity, he oversaw curriculum development, faculty training, student services, and academic policy implementation—ensuring that MSU Buug maintained high educational standards while remaining responsive to the needs of its largely Muslim and indigenous student population.

Current Roles

Since 2023, Dr. Bandera has been serving as a **Faculty member** in the **Department of Agribusiness Management** at the College of Agriculture, Mindanao State University Marawi—his alma mater. Teaching courses on agricultural marketing, financial management, and agribusiness strategy, he has mentored a new generation of agricultural entrepreneurs and development practitioners. His classroom approach is known for integrating real-world case studies, field research, and community-based projects, ensuring that students graduate with both theoretical grounding and practical skills.

Also in 2023, Dr. Bandera continued to build his name in international academic publishing, with his works appearing in peer-reviewed journals that feature research across various fields. Through his studies, he brings attention to issues that matter—especially those connected to science, technology, and the realities of Southeast Asia. His publications reflect not only academic rigor but also a clear sense of purpose in contributing meaningful knowledge to the field.

Research and Publications

Dr. Bandera's most remarkable achievement is his extraordinary research productivity. As of 2025, he has authored or co-authored **49 international publications** in peer-reviewed journals—a staggering output for someone in their early thirties. His research spans multiple domains, including crop science, soil fertility, organic and inorganic fertilizer application, phytochemical analysis, agribusiness economics, financial management, marketing systems, and environmental sustainability.

His work has appeared in prestigious international journals such as the **European Modern Studies Journal**, **International European Extended Enablement in Science, Engineering & Management (IEEE SEM)**, **International Journal of Innovative Science and Research Technology**, **Asian Research Journal of Agriculture**, **Journal of Business Economics and Agribusiness**, **GAS Journal of Economics and Business Management**, **International Journal of Business Marketing and Management**, and **American Journal of Economics and Business Innovation**.

Notable research themes in Dr. Bandera's portfolio include:

- **Crop production optimization**: Studies on pechay (*Brassica napus*), corn (*Zea mays*), peanut (*Arachis hypogaea*), green onion (*Allium fistulosum*), lettuce (*Lactuca sativa*), and durian (*Durio zibethinus*) under various fertilizer regimes and soil conditions.
- **Phytochemical screening**: Analysis of medicinal and agricultural plants such as *Plectranthus amboinicus* (oregano), papaya leaf (*Carica papaya*), and other tropical species to assess their chemical properties and economic potential.
- **Mushroom cultivation**: Research on spawn production and return on investment for oyster mushrooms (*Pleurotus florida*, *Pleurotus ostreatus*), reishi (*Ganoderma lucidum*), and milky mushroom (*Calocybe indica*) using sawdust substrates.
- **Financial management in agribusiness**: Literature reviews and analytical studies on investment appraisal, risk and return analysis, financial accounting, and management accounting as applied to agricultural enterprises.
- **Marketing and value chains**: Systematic reviews of marketing subsystems in agriculture, fisheries, and forestry; analysis of market-centered expansion strategies and boundary-driven growth in agribusiness.
- **Sustainability and environmental stewardship**: Reviews on green human resource management, microplastic pollution in aquatic ecosystems, food waste, and LEAN thinking in Philippine agribusiness.
- **Systemic approaches to agriculture**: Research on farming systems integration, intercropping with legumes as green manure, and the application of systems thinking to link sectors, resources, and marketing channels.

Dr. Bandera's research philosophy is rooted in the belief that agricultural development must be evidence-based, contextually relevant, and economically viable. He frequently collaborates with student researchers, government agencies, and local farming communities to ensure that his studies address real-world problems and generate actionable insights.

Contributions to Sustainable Development

Beyond his academic publications, Dr. Bandera has been a vocal advocate for sustainable development in Muslim Mindanao. His doctoral research in sustainable economic development explored how agribusiness can serve as a vehicle for poverty reduction, food security, and environmental conservation in conflict-affected and marginalized regions. He has emphasized the need for financial management systems that account for smallholder farmers' limited access to credit, the importance of market linkages that reduce post-harvest losses, and the potential of organic farming to restore degraded soils while improving farmer incomes.

Dr. Bandera has also contributed to policy discussions on agricultural development in BARMM, drawing on his experience as a government technologist and his research expertise. He has argued for greater investment in agricultural research and development (R&D), stronger extension services, and policies that incentivize sustainable farming practices such as crop diversification, integrated pest management, and agroforestry.

Recognition and Impact

Although still early in his career, Dr. Bandera has already gained recognition within academic and agricultural circles. His role as Vice Chancellor speaks to the trust placed in his leadership, while his growing body of work—49 publications to date—demonstrates both consistency and depth. Many of these studies focus on pressing concerns in Philippine agriculture and have been cited by fellow researchers and practitioners working on similar challenges across the region.

More importantly, Dr. Bandera's work has had tangible impacts on farming communities in Lanao del Sur and neighboring provinces. His extension work and applied research have helped farmers adopt better crop management practices, improve yields, and increase profitability. His advocacy for sustainable agriculture has inspired students and young professionals to pursue careers in agricultural science and development.

Challenges and Future Directions

Like many researchers in the Global South, Dr. Bandera faces challenges related to limited research funding, inadequate laboratory facilities, and the difficulty of balancing teaching, administration, and research. The agricultural sector in BARMM, while rich in potential, suffers from underinvestment, poor infrastructure, and the lingering effects of decades of conflict. Translating research findings into policy and practice remains a persistent challenge, as does the need to build stronger partnerships between universities, government agencies, and the private sector.

Looking ahead, Dr. Bandera is expected to continue expanding his research portfolio, complete his second doctorate in Business Administration, and take on even more significant leadership roles within the MSU system and beyond. There is speculation that he may eventually move into national-level policy or international development work, given his expertise in sustainable economic development and his deep commitment to uplifting marginalized communities.

Personal Life

Dr. Bandera is single and resides in Maguing, Lanao del Sur. He is fluent in Meranaw (his mother tongue), Filipino, Bisaya, and English—a linguistic versatility that allows him to engage with diverse communities across Mindanao and the broader Philippines. Despite his demanding academic schedule, he remains deeply connected to his roots in rural Lanao, often visiting farming communities to stay grounded in the realities that drive his research.

Legacy

Dr. Abdani D. Bandera represents a new generation of Filipino scholars who are reshaping the landscape of agricultural science and development in Muslim Mindanao. His work demonstrates that rigorous research, when combined with cultural sensitivity and a commitment to community service, can drive meaningful change in

regions long overlooked by mainstream development efforts. As both a scientist and an administrator, he has shown that young leaders from marginalized communities can excel on the global stage while remaining rooted in their local contexts.

His legacy, still in the making, is one of intellectual rigor, institutional leadership, and unwavering dedication to the proposition that agriculture—when approached scientifically, sustainably, and equitably—can be a powerful engine for poverty reduction, food security, and environmental stewardship in the Philippines and beyond.

External Links

- Official Email (mailto:abdani.bandera@msumain.edu.ph)
- Mindanao State University Official Website (https://www.msumain.edu.ph)
- Profile provided by Yuri DB (https://www.facebook.com/robert.rowland.670865)

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